

FAITH LIFT

THREE LEVELS OF FAITH

1 Corinthians 12 lists nine gifts of the Holy Spirit. These nine Gifts can be classified in three categories:

- Revelation Gifts - Word of Wisdom, Word of Knowledge, and Discerning of Spirits.
- Vocal Gifts – Prophecy, Tongues, and Interpretation of Tongues.
- Power Gifts – Faith, Healing, and miracles.

I would like to begin this book by talking about Three Levels of Faith.

This statement may come as a shock to you, if you have a religious mindset... One does not have to be saved to possess and exercise faith! Think of this:

- Every time a person steps on an airplane, they are exercising faith in the pilot and the equipment!
- Every time a person steps into an elevator, they are exercising faith in the manufacturer and the machine!
- Every time a person gets into an automobile, they are exercising faith in their own ability and the ability of the vehicle!

Romans 12:3 (KJV) *"God has given to EVERY person, THE measure of faith."* While the abilities and intellect of each person on the Earth is very different, it is true that initially all people have been given the same measure of faith to begin life with. God started each of us off with as

much faith as he started the Apostle Paul and Smith Wigglesworth off with! How we develop the faith we have been given determines what we can do with it.

There are three ways we receive faith:

- Faith is imparted...
- Faith is given as a fruit of the spirit...
- Faith is given as a gift...

Nothing is more pleasing to the Lord than to see his people walking out and operating in faith! Hebrews 11:6 (NKJV) *"But without faith it is impossible to please God: for he that comes to God must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of them that diligently seek Him."*

IMPARTED FAITH

The impartation of this gift occurs at the moment of conception. It comes installed in the intellect. Imparted faith gives us the capacity to receive, possess, exercise, and cultivate faith.

We are commanded to develop our intellect to its maximum potential so we can offer it to God for His use. [2 Timothy 2:15](#) (KJV) *"Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth."* Just as we are responsible as human beings to develop our intellect, we are responsible to exercise and increase our faith.

THE FRUIT OF FAITH

Faith is not only imparted at conception; it is planted as a seed at conversion. In Luke 8 Jesus gives the parable of the sower and the seed. In verse 11 He explains the parable, *"Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God."* Everyone of us, saved and unsaved have been given

“The Measure of faith.” The seed of faith is in us, believers and unbelievers alike! All of us have the capacity to believe! What we choose to do with the faith we have been given will largely determine the impact we make on this planet, as well as the influence we will be able to exercise over people and in eternity. Faith is a big deal and most of us need some Faith Lifts from time to time!

Not only have we been given faith to begin our time on this planet, John 1:12 tells us God has given us ***“The power to become the sons of God.”*** Every person on earth has the ***Power to become a son or daughter of God***” which opens a pathway to even more faith! What is the ***“Power to become the sons of God?”*** It is Faith! The faith we were given at birth is ENOUGH faith to get us to God and ENOUGH faith to make us into one of His sons and daughters.

At conversion the seed of the fruit of the spirit is deposited in our lives. Whether or not that fruit ever comes to maturity depends totally on how the individual responds to it and cultivates it.

Faith is also a component of the fruit of the spirit, listed in Galatians 5:22. How do we cultivate and grow imparted faith and faith as a Fruit of the Spirit? Romans 10:17 ***“Faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.”***

Once the seed of faith has been planted at conversion, we begin the process of developing faith into mature fruit, through the study, memorization, and practice of the Word of God.

The fruit of faith is what God does through us; walking out His Word, learning to stand on His promises; the gift of faith is what God does for us.

We are saved by faith, not by works. But once we are converted, we continually receive Faith Lifts by mixing faith with works.

THE GIFT OF FAITH

God wants us as His children to have faith, so much so, that He has provided it for us through as many sources and channels as possible.

Faith is the only ingredient mentioned in both the Galatian list of fruit and the Corinthian list of gifts.

The gift of faith goes far beyond just believing God is able, to the point of speaking things into existence that seem totally irrational to the human mind.

This kind of faith moves us into a place where God honors our word as his own, and miraculously brings it to pass.

God did this in the Old Testament when the Prophet Ezekiel prophesied to the dry bones and they came back to life and actually became a living breathing, functioning army! Faith can bring dry bones to life again!

God did this for Paul and Silas in Acts 16! At midnight they were praying and singing praises to God! God honored their words by shaking the Philippian jail with an earthquake, not only were they freed from prison, the jailor and his entire house were saved. Faith can free us from whatever has us bound!

The gift of faith produces a confidence in God and His word that defies human reasoning, satanic obstacles, doubt, and unbelief. It says I will believe no matter what, simply because God said it! When the gift of faith is functioning properly, it will produce the following things:

- Supernatural blessing...
- Supernatural protection...
- Supernatural provision...
- Supernatural strength...

Faith is the switch that opens God's powerhouse. Faith sees the invisible, believes the incredible, and claims the impossible. Mark 11:22-24 (NKJV) *"So Jesus answered and said to them, "Have faith in God.²³ "For assuredly, I say to you, whoever says to this mountain, 'Be removed and be cast into the sea,' and does not doubt in his heart, but believes that those things he says will be done, he will have whatever he says.²⁴ "Therefore I say to you, whatever things you ask when you pray, believe that you receive them, and you will have them."*

Faith is not a guarantee against problems... Faith is a guarantee against defeat!

My natural Father has more faith than any person I have ever known. As a result, I have had a front row seat to see the miraculous my entire life. I grew up thinking that people of great faith were oblivious to fear or unbelief. I have learned that people who exercise great faith probably face more fear than any of us, but they have learned to do what they do – Afraid! What conquers fear? Faith! God doesn't respond to desperation, if He did, there would be no desperate people in the world – He responds to faith, and faith alone!

Those who see signs, miracles, and wonders disregard fear and unbelief and allow their natural faith, the faith they have been given as a fruit of the Spirit, and the faith they have received in their gift plex to come together to see the miraculous.

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How are we to allow faith to operate in our lives?

- Develop imparted faith as far as it will take us... Study, educate ourselves, take advantage of all educational opportunities.

- Develop the fruit of faith in our lives... Pray, Study His Word! Consume His Word! Stand on God's Word! Put God to the test!
- Discover His faithfulness... His past performance is a good indicator of His future activity!
- Ask God to allow the gift of faith to operate through us... Look for opportunities to release faith!
- Respond to the instructions of the Holy Spirit... It is important that we do what He say's – Not what we think should be done!
- Speak faith into faithless situations... Remember – Nothing is impossible with God (It is impossible for God to do nothing) – Because we have imparted faith, fruitful faith and gifted faith – It should be impossible for us to do nothing!
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ACKNOWLEDGE THE ENEMY, BUT KEEP YOUR EYES ON THE LORD

In the fourteenth chapter of the book of Exodus, the Children of Israel followed God into a cul-de-sac between hostile hills and the edge of a sea too deep to be forded, and too wide to be crossed. The unmistakable indication of Exodus 14:1-4 is that the Lord took responsibility for leading them into peril. He gave them specific, step-by-step instructions, leading them down a route to apparent ruin: ***“Turn and camp; camp there; there, before the entrapping sea; yes, right there in that impossible place.”***

How could Moses and Aaron keep from worrying when the Red Sea was facing them; the mountains were beside them; the soldiers of Egypt were bearing down on them with swords drawn? It was certain that the

Egyptians were not one bit concerned about a confrontation with the Israelites because these people had spent the last 400 years living as slaves. Not one of them had been trained in the intricacies of warfare nor did one of them own a weapon! What the Egyptians did not know is that the Israelites did not need a weapon; they did not need to know how to fight; they had a secret weapon, and His name was Jehovah!

What helped create faith in a moment of terror was the fact that they knew Jehovah delivered them from Egypt and that it was His will for them to go to Canaan! Moses determined that they were where they were not by their own will, but according to the will of God!

Please understand that God was not being disingenuous to Israel! He was about to deal with Israel's enemies once and for all! He was about to allow them to see Him in a way they had never seen Him before! He was about to provide them with weapons to protect themselves, during the forty plus years of wilderness wandering!

Life can be very, very difficult. If we are walking through a difficult spot, we are not so out of step with the general population, or the most spiritual people in the Kingdom. The reason life can be so difficult is because God has appointed a destiny for us, and there is a real, live enemy who will do everything in his power to sabotage and keep us back from reaching our ultimate potential.

We must bear in mind, our enemy is not our parents, professors, boss or the government; our enemy is satan and satan alone! On the other hand, the Lord has committed Himself to being our constant companion and even fighting our battles for us.

There is no question that Israel had an enemy, and that enemy was consistently bent on destruction and demise. Look at what Israel was facing. Exodus 14:5-9 (CEV) ***“When the king of Egypt heard that the Israelites had finally left, he and his officials changed their minds and said, “Look what we have done! We let them get away, and they will no longer be our slaves.”⁶ The king got his war chariot and army ready. ⁷ He commanded his officers in charge of his six hundred best chariots and all his other chariots to start after the Israelites. ⁸ The LORD made the king so stubborn that he went after them, even though the Israelites proudly went on their way.”***

The Israelites could have denied the existence of an enemy, but that would not have changed the fact that a hostile king was in hot pursuit of this group of emancipated slaves. Denial of the enemy never calms his hostilities, but the acknowledgement of his existence demands readiness on the part of Christ followers. Charles Spurgeon once said, *“The great tyrant has not forgotten you, and he designs your capture and re-enslavement.”*

The devil sometimes launches direct, frontal attacks against us, but he is usually more conniving and insidious than picking an overt fight against Kingdom citizens. Ephesians 6:12 describes in detail what we are up against. (NKJV) ***“For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places.”*** Ladies and Gentlemen, this is not a fight against flesh and blood, this is spiritual warfare at the highest levels, and it is for the highest prize – Our eternal souls!

Whenever the enemy attacks, whether covertly or overtly, he is normally closer and cruder than we first imagined, much like the Pharaoh of the Exodus. When we engage our enemy, we should always acknowledge his existence, while keeping our eyes on the Lord.

I want us to consider the parallels between Pharaoh and satan:

- Both are unyielding enemies!
- Both covet power over their subjects!
- Both are enraged beyond reason!
- Both have assembled vast armies meant for destruction!
- Both will eventually be plundered by the Almighty!

The Bible likens Satan to five different animals:

- In Genesis 3, he's a serpent trying to deceive God's people.
- In Matthew 13, he's a bird trying to defile God's harvest.
- In John 10, He's a wolf attacking God's flock.
- In First Peter, he's a lion trying to devour God's children.
- In Revelation 12, he's a dragon wanting to destroy God's Son.

There is little question about the intentions of our enemy. He is malicious, malignant and venomous. He is not tempting us to allow us to have a good time; he is attempting to destroy everything in our lives and to drag us down to Hell.

This is not the kind of enemy we can defeat simply with the denial of his existence or presence. Defeating our enemy will require far more than confessing we do not have an adversary!

How do we overcome such a persistent and malignant opponent? We would do well to remember the following things:

- The blood of Jesus Christ forgives our sins and resolves our guilt!
- The resurrection frees us from the fear of death and satisfies our need for eternal significance and happiness!
- The presence of the Lord surrounds us!
- The promises of the Bible sustain us!
- The grace of God heals the wounds this world inflicts upon us!
- Our testimony becomes our triumphant shout and the final nail in the coffin of the enemy!

Jesus said, John 8:36 (NKJV) *“Therefore if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed.”*

This enemy doesn't surrender his prey without a fight. He comes racing after us, chariot wheels churning the dust, seeking to discourage and defeat us. He pursues us with the intensity of the Pharaoh of Exodus.

He may use our own friends or family members! He sometimes uses the weapon of persecution! He often uses the weapon of discouragement! He tries to use the lack of acceptance as a weapon of discouragement against us! He will not hesitate to use the trick of personal financial situations to his advantage! He is not above pointing out hypocrites in the church to get us off track! He will do everything he can to bring about an onslaught of temptation! He is such a scum bag that he will orchestrate a barrage of troubles and trials against us, using the weakest and most frail people in our lives to do it! We can be assured; our enemy will attempt to trap us in our troubles; entangle us in our dilemmas; corner us in an impossible situation; or lure us into temptation.

We must stop blaming God for all these maladies occurring in our lives! When we find ourselves in a tough situation suffering pain, worry, anguish, illness, or temptation, we can rest assured the devil is undoubtedly behind it. John 10:10 (NKJV) *“The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly.”*

Here is where we must turn the tables on the enemy! Of course, we should acknowledge satan's activity, but rest assured we will not be intimidated by him. We can resist him in the power of God and by the blood of Jesus Christ! In fact, our Commander in chief enjoins us to such resistance. When threatened by the devil's schemes, we should stand on the Word. Daniel 11:32 (CEV) *“The king will use deceit to win followers from those who are unfaithful to God, but those who remain faithful will do everything possible to oppose him.”* James 4:7-8 (CEV) *“Surrender to God! Resist the devil, and he will run from you.”*

8 Come near to God, and he will come near to you. Clean up your lives, you sinners. Purify your hearts, you people who can't make up your mind." 1 Peter 5:9 (CEV) "But you must resist the devil and stay strong in your faith. You know that all over the world the Lord's followers are suffering just as you are."

In our effort to resist the enemy we should employ every weapon and piece of armor that has been made available to us. 2 Corinthians 10:3-6 (NKJV) ***"For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war according to the flesh.⁴ For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds,⁵ casting down arguments and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ,⁶ and being ready to punish all disobedience when your obedience is fulfilled."***

We should resist the enemy in the name of Jesus Christ, we should stand our ground; and we should shake off discouragement the moment it is initiated! When we do this, the enemy is doomed to be drowned in the Red Sea of the blood of Jesus Christ. Every time we resist the slightest temptation, we honor God. Every time we overcome even the smallest problem by trusting and obeying our Lord Jesus, God is glorified in our lives.

We must make the conscious decision that at every tempting point we will always choose:

- Character over convenience!
- Faithfulness over ease!
- Honesty over deceit!

Do we have an enemy? Yes! Will we experience problems? Yes! Will we be defeated? No!

Look at the patriarch Job and how he faced his difficulties courageously! In one terrible season:

- He lost his herds to barbarians!
- He lost his children to a tornado!
- He lost his health to a disease!
- He lost his wealth to misfortune!
- He lost his friends to a critical spirit!
- He lost his wife to doubt!

Job seemed to be oblivious to the fact that as he sat among the ashes scraping his boils with pottery shards and bemoaning his fate, that an enemy who was bent on destroying his soul had orchestrated his problems. This was nonetheless a fact! The enemy was behind every negative thing that happened to Job! But much to the enemy's chagrin, Job emerged on the other side of the trial with his faith intact and his attitude optimistic! The reason he was able to persevere is because he acknowledged he had an enemy, but he kept his eyes on the Lord. You don't have to believe me that this was Job's posture, listen to his own words! ***"Though God slay me yet I will trust him. If worms destroy this body, I intend to see God face to face."***

As a result of Job acknowledging the enemy but keeping his eyes on the Lord, God gave him twice as much as he had before the trial. He was 70 when the trial began, and he lived to be 210!

The story is told of Martin Luther awakening in the middle of the night with the devil standing at the foot of his bed! He rose up, took one look at the devil and said, *"Oh it's just you!"* With that, he rolled over and went back to sleep.

The devil came to church one Sunday and started shouting insults at the crowd. Everyone vacated the building except one little old man. The devil shouted to the old man, *"Don't you know who I am?"* To which the man calmly replied, *"Yes."* The devil said, *"Are you not afraid of me?"* The man said *"no."* The devil could not believe his ears and said,

“Why are you not afraid of me?” The man replied, “I was married to your sister for fifty five years!”

Since the same devil orchestrates similar attacks against us today, what would be a proper response? We draw near to Christ and keep ourselves under the protective cloud of His grace. Acknowledge the enemy and keep our focus on Jesus!

In Exodus 14, Pharaoh could threaten with brute force and protest; he could stir up frightening clouds of chariot dust; he could terrify with a thousand swords. But he was powerless to harm the Israelites as long as they remained under the protective cloud of God's glory and grace. That cloud which became darkness to the Egyptians was a light to the Israelites. The same is true of us, the very thing that defeats the enemy gives victory to Christ followers – That ingredient is faith! Acknowledge the enemy but keep your eyes on the Lord!

If we walk in His will there is nothing that hell can devise which will be successful against us! Isaiah 54:17 (NKJV) **“No weapon formed against you shall prosper, And every tongue which rises against you in judgment You shall condemn. This is the heritage of the servants of the LORD, And their righteousness is from Me,” Says the LORD.**

We must acknowledge our enemy while keeping our eyes on the Lord.

Think of this, as much as the enemy attempted to throw everything possible at the Apostle Paul, Paul acknowledged that he had an enemy but kept his focus on the Lord. For all his insights and explanations about the evil one, the apostle Paul, in reality, focused on Christ. In the Pauline letters:

- The word *Jesus* occurs in 219 verses!
- The word *Lord* in 272 verses!
- The word *Christ* in 389 verses!
- The word *Satan* in only 10 verses!

- The word *devil* in only 6 verses!

The reason the Children of Israel were successful against their enemy at the Red Sea is because Moses and Aaron refused to divert their attention from the Lord to Pharaoh. They acknowledged the pursuit of the Egyptians but decided to focus on what Jehovah was about to do!

Let's look at the Miracle of the Red Sea crossing:

- The winds blew with such force that the sea split!
- The waters of the Red Sea became towering walls to point the path of deliverance to the Children of Israel!
- The Israelites passed through on DRY ground in one night's time!
- The Lord dried the Red Sea out and didn't as much as leave a footprint in the Sea!

All of this happened to prove to the Israelites and to us that when we are being pelted by the distractions, temptations, and accusations of the enemy, if we acknowledge the enemy but keep our eyes on the Lord, God will make a way when there seems to be no way!

Exodus 14 provides us a biblical model of how to properly process difficulties by faith, in the light of God's almighty:

- Presence! He is omnipresent!
- Providence! He is omniscient!
- Promise! He is a God who cannot lie!
- Power! He is omnipotent!

Ladies and Gentlemen, the Red Sea may stretch out in front of us; the issues of life may seem to be about to entrap us; the enemy may be hot on our heels; the future may seem most difficult; but God works in ways

we cannot fathom! This one thing I am sure of, God will make a way of escape for His children! Isaiah 43:19 (CEV) ***“I am creating something new. There it is! Do you see it? I have put roads in deserts, streams in thirsty lands.”*** 1 Corinthians 10:13 (CEV) ***“You are tempted in the same way that everyone else is tempted. But God can be trusted not to let you be tempted too much, and he will show you how to escape from your temptations.”*** Colossians 4:2-3 (CEV) ***“Never give up praying. And when you pray, keep alert and be thankful. 3 Be sure to pray that God will make a way for us to spread his message and explain the mystery about Christ, even though I am in jail for doing this.”***

Remember:

- Nothing is deeper than the ocean of His love!
- No army is stronger than you and the Lord!
- No force is greater than the Lord working on behalf of His people!
- No enemy exists who can overcome the child of God who has decided to acknowledge the enemy but keep their eyes on the Lord!

When things are going badly; when we feel trapped between the sword and the sea; when we are under assault; we must acknowledge the enemy but keep our eyes on Christ!

He will see us through! He will make a way where there seems to be no way!

DOING THE RIDICULOUS RECEIVING THE MIRACULOUS

1 Kings 17:8-16 (NKJV) *“Then the word of the LORD came to him, saying, ⁹ ‘Arise, go to Zarephath, which belongs to Sidon, and dwell there. See, I have commanded a widow there to provide for you.’” ¹⁰ So he arose and went to Zarephath. And when he came to the gate of the city, indeed a widow was there gathering sticks. And he called to her and said, “Please bring me a little water in a cup, that I may drink.” ¹¹ And as she was going to get it, he called to her and said, “Please bring me a morsel of bread in your hand.” ¹² So she said, “As the LORD your God lives, I do not have bread, only a handful of flour in a bin, and a little oil in a jar; and see, I am gathering a couple of sticks that I may go in and prepare it for myself and my son, that we may eat it, and die.” ¹³ And Elijah said to her, “Do not fear; go and do as you have said, but make me a small cake from it first, and bring it to me; and afterward make some for yourself and your son. ¹⁴ For thus says the LORD God of Israel: ‘The bin of flour shall not be used up, nor shall the jar of oil run dry, until the day the LORD sends rain on the earth.’” ¹⁵ So she went away and did according to the word of Elijah; and she and he and her household ate for many days. ¹⁶ The bin of flour was not*

used up, nor did the jar of oil run dry, according to the word of the LORD which He spoke by Elijah.”

The back story to this passage of Scripture is that the Prophet Elijah had prophesied a 3 ½ year drought to Ahab. This prophecy of drought came as a result of the wickedness of leadership in the land and the ungodly practiced being played out among Gods people. After Elijah enacted the mandate of God upon the hand is preventing the heavens from giving rain, God go provided for Elijah by sending him to the brook Cherith where the Lord kept the stream flowing and then sent ravens with bread and flesh in the morning and in the evening. Ladies and Gentlemen, water from a stream in the desert, was as big a deal as scavengers giving up their food to feed one beleaguered prophet, running from the wrath of a King. In the course of time (We are not sure the length of days) the brook dried up! When the brook dried up, the ravens stopped air lifting meals twice a day, and the man of God had to leave the brook Cherith. At this juncture, God sent Elijah to Zarephath and there he engages in a conversation with a widow who was financially destitute.

Notice verses 10-13 (NKJV) ***“So he arose and went to Zarephath. And when he came to the gate of the city, indeed a widow was there gathering sticks. And he called to her and said, “Please bring me a little water in a cup, that I may drink.”¹¹ And as she was going to get it, he called to her and said, “Please bring me a morsel of bread in your hand.”¹² So she said, “As the LORD your God lives, I do not have bread, only a handful of flour in a bin, and a little oil in a jar; and see, I am gathering a couple of sticks that I may go in and prepare it for myself and my son, that we may eat it, and die.”¹³ And Elijah said to her, “Do not fear; go and do as you have said, but make me a small cake from it first, and bring it to me; and afterward make some for yourself and your son.”*** “ The Prophet Elijah does something here that I find to be over the top; out of bounds; even bordering on being ridiculous; he asks a widow who has just enough meal and oil left for some bread for she and her son to make him a cake first!

If Elijah was a real man of God, he would find a way to help this family, rather than requiring them to give him all they possessed, wouldn't he? This request from Elijah to the widow of Zarephath would have been splashed all over social media in our day!

There are times in our lives when the path to healing, help and prosperity is purposely planned through ridiculous territory!

- Abraham was told to go, but not told where to go!
- Moses was commanded to take off his shoes in a hot desert!
- David was instructed to fight a giant with a slingshot!
- The Three Hebrew Children were directed not to bow despite the temperature of the fire!
- Despite his education and upward trajectory in the religious establishment, the Apostle Paul was charged to lay down his life for the sake of the Gospel!

RIDICULOUS REQUESTS

The Prophet Elijah told the woman that if she would feed him first, “*The bin of flour shall not be used up, nor shall the jar of oil run dry, until the day the LORD sends rain on the earth.*”

Ridiculous requests lead to ridiculous results! What ridiculous thing is God saying to you today? Are we going to do it or are we going to allow this opportunity to exercise faith to pass us by once again?

RIDICULOUS ACTIONS

One would think this lady would tell the man of God to get lost! This appears to be another greedy preacher looking for a hand-out! But wait a minute! Look at what she does! Verse 15 (NKJV) ***“So she went away and did according to the word of Elijah.”*** This lady never so much as questioned the words of Elijah. She just took what seemed to be a ridiculous action! This is faith at its best! I am sure the enemy was screaming in her ears that if she did this, she and her son would both die! She did what most people of great faith do, she did it afraid!

Ridiculous actions lead on to ridiculous faith! Hebrews 11:1 (CEV) ***“Faith makes us sure of what we hope for and gives us proof of what we cannot see.”***

Hebrews 11:6 (NKJV) ***“But without faith it is impossible to please Him, for he who comes to God must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.”***

Hebrews eleven is my favorite chapter of the Bible! It also provides for us the following information:

- By faith the Elders obtained a good report...
- By faith we believe God created the Earth...

- By faith Able offered a better sacrifice than Cain...
- By faith Enoch escaped death...
- By faith Noah built an Ark and saved his family as well as the human race...
- By faith Abraham looked for a City...
- By faith Abraham offered Isaac...
- By faith Isaac passed the blessing of Abraham to Jacob and Esau...
- By faith Jacob passed the blessing of Abraham to the son's of Joseph...
- By faith Joseph looked for a country beyond Egypt...
- By faith Moses led the Children of Israel out of Egypt...
- By faith Rahab saved the spies and became an ancestor of Christ...

If we need a ridiculous blessing we may be called upon to take a ridiculous action! Trust me, everyone who operated in great faith in Hebrews eleven knew what the giant of fear looked like, smelled like, acted like! But they did what they did, despite the fear that had to be overcome.

Are we going to operate in a Faith Lift and do what we know to do, or are we going to sit on the sidelines and allow the miracles of God to pass us by!

MIRACULOUS RESULTS...

1 Kings 17:15-16 (NKJV) *“She went away and did according to the word of Elijah; and she and he and her household ate for many days. ¹⁶ The bin of flour was not used up, nor did the jar of oil run dry, according to the word of the LORD which He spoke by Elijah.”*

We are not told exactly how much time went by between the time this widow made a cake for the man of God, believing she and her son would be taken care of. The Bible just says *“She and her son did eat many days.”*

What we are sure of is that the drought lasted 3 ½ years! It is possible the meal and oil lasted for a thousand days or more! The oil and meal did not grow; it just stayed!

Sometimes God does not choose to allow us to see the reserves; He just allows us to see the bare minimum and asks us to trust Him, believing there is more than enough!

When we step out in obedient faith to do the ridiculous, God has obligated himself to do the miraculous!

Those who need the miraculous will probably be required to set the miracle in motion by doing the ridiculous! We are often guilty of sitting on the sidelines doing nothing, waiting on God to send the right opportunity for our miracle when God has already given us the raw material

to bring the thing to pass. After all He has given us natural faith, the fruit of faith, and the gift of faith! What are we waiting for?

When this lady stepped out in obedient faith, doing the ridiculous, she set in motion the miraculous for her and her family!

As with most miracles, the miracle itself is a precursor to what God really wants to do. This lady and her son had sufficient food for as much as a thousand days, but God was just building her faith to receive the greatest miracle of her life. I Kings 17:17-24 (NKJV) ***“Now it happened after these things that the son of the woman who owned the house became sick. And his sickness was so serious that there was no breath left in him. ¹⁸ So she said to Elijah, “What have I to do with you, O man of God? Have you come to me to bring my sin to remembrance, and to kill my son?” ¹⁹ And he said to her, “Give me your son.” So he took him out of her arms and carried him to the upper room where he was staying, and laid him on his own bed. ²⁰ Then he cried out to the LORD and said, “O LORD my God, have You also brought tragedy on the widow with whom I lodge, by killing her son?” ²¹ And he stretched himself out on the child three times, and cried out to the LORD and said, “O LORD my God,***

I pray, let this child's soul come back to him.”²² Then the LORD heard the voice of Elijah; and the soul of the child came back to him, and he revived.²³ And Elijah took the child and brought him down from the upper room into the house, and gave him to his mother. And Elijah said, “See, your son lives!”²⁴ Then the woman said to Elijah, “Now by this I know that you are a man of God, and that the word of the LORD in your mouth is the truth.”

If this woman had not trusted the man of God with the little things, she could never have trusted him for her son! The miracle of the meal and oil was just a starter miracle for what would follow!

What is God getting us ready for? Are we going to pass or fail the present test? If we fail this test, it will set us up for defeat, later! If we pass this test, we will be placing ourselves and our families in the pathway of a blessing at a more crucial time!

The bottom line is, whether we need food or a resurrection, if we need the miraculous, we must be willing to do the ridiculous!

What does a Faith Lift look like in our lives?

- If we need a financial miracle, we must give a ridiculous offering...
- If we need a miracle of healing, we must trust God in a ridiculous way... (Pray for someone else)
- If we need a relational miracle, we must humble ourselves before man, taking the high road of humility...
- If we need a spiritual miracle, we must find a place to serve others...
- If we need a miracle of cooperation, we must submit ourselves to those who have authority over us...